

MSc ENR IUNR ZHAW
FS2026

Specialized MSc in GIScience
GEO 880
FS2026

Introduction semester project

Zurich University
of Applied Sciences



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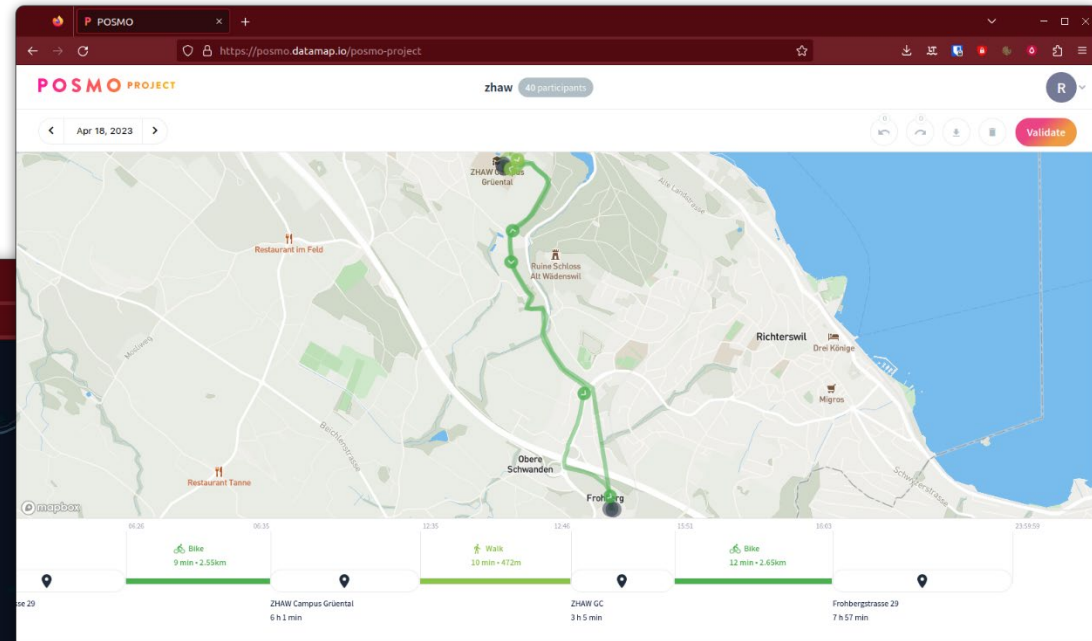
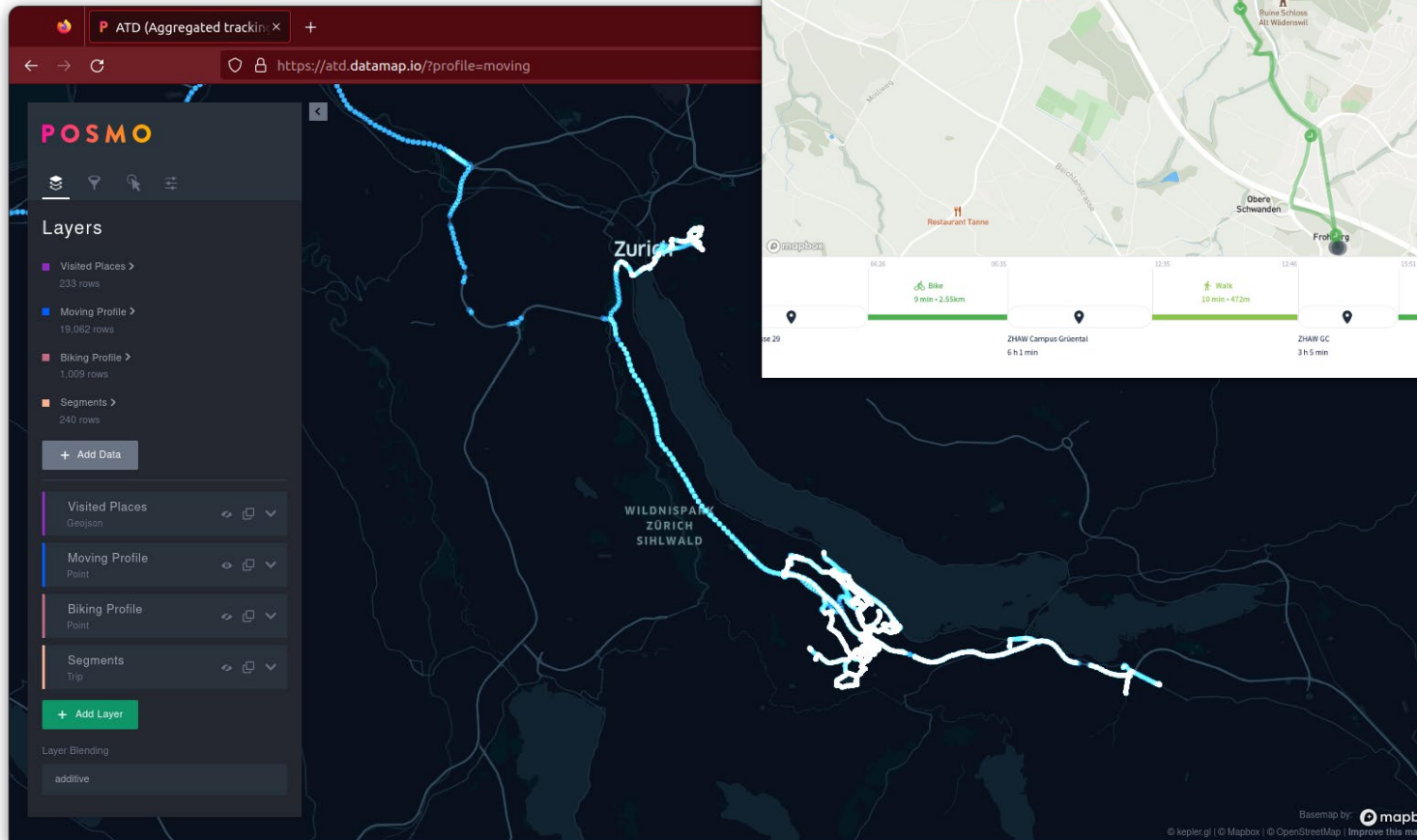


**University of
Zurich^{UZH}**

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Semester-Project



Learning objectives Semester Project



You develop data science skills that you can transfer to your own projects requiring data processing. Specifically, you develop the following skills:

- ✓ You develop exploratory **data science** skills, where you iteratively develop hypotheses about your data and support your hypothesis with quantitative evidence and visualizations.
- ✓ You are able to parse, process, structure, filter, aggregate, and visualize your **data** in the software environment R and tidyverse.
- ✓ You can design and implement basic data science procedures (let's call them **algorithms**) with R, in accordance with the theory.
- ✓ You can **critically evaluate** a given data source, discuss its limitations and potential suitability for the given analytical tasks.

Semester-Project



- Travel mode detection
- Street type preferences, e.g. Slope, diurnal patterns
- Link to weather data, e.g. street preferences vs. weather, commuting patterns vs. weather



- Primarily use the **data you collected yourself**, or
- we have a big dataset on partially annotated data from the **Geolife** project, or
- if you have still **other movement data** get in touch with us.

- We'll set up a pool with all your (shared) data

► Show the code

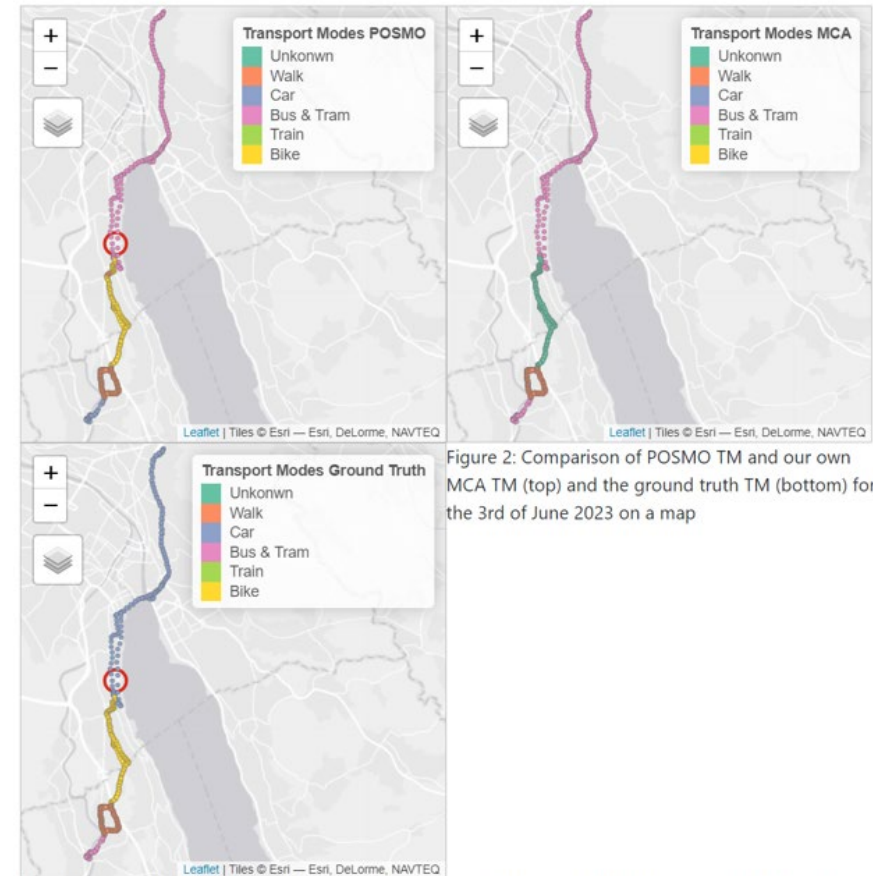


Figure 2: Comparison of POSMO TM and our own MCA TM (top) and the ground truth TM (bottom) for the 3rd of June 2023 on a map

The TMD as specified in this project is overall less accurate than to the POSMO-integrated TMD when compared to the validated data, with 45% vs. 60%.

Improved Transport Mode Detection
Semesterproject, Lukas Bieri & Valentin Hett (FS23)

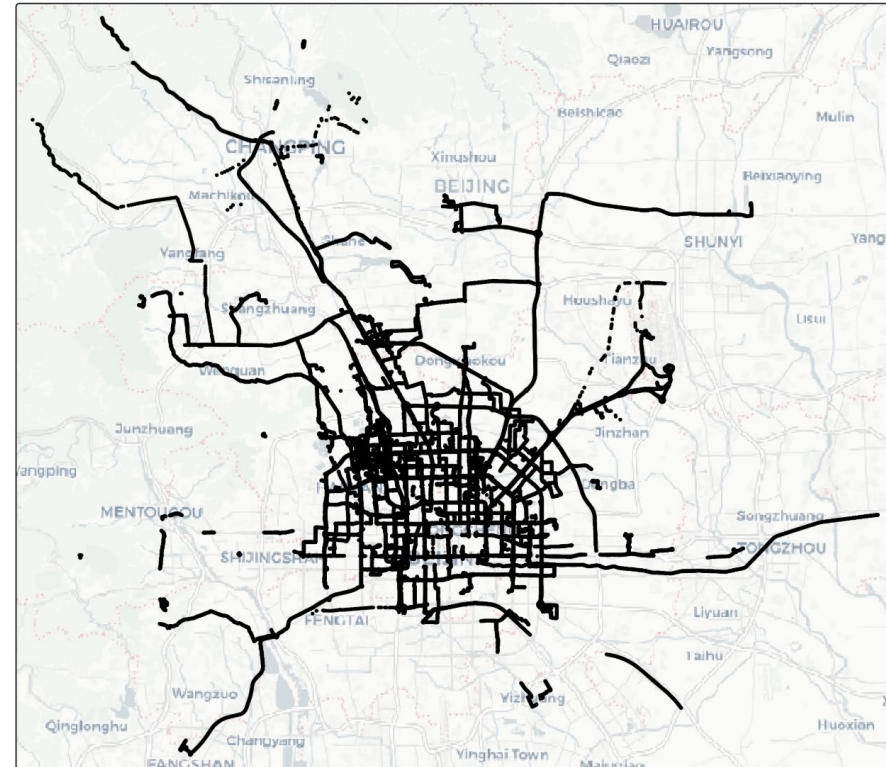
Semester-Project



- Travel mode detection
- Street type preferences, e.g. Slope, diurnal patterns
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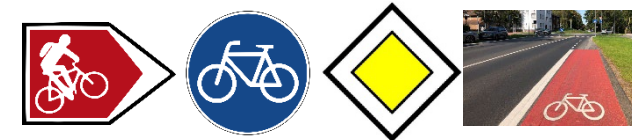
<https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/research/publication/geolife-gps-trajectory-dataset-user-guide/>

- We'll set up a pool with all your (shared) data

Possible Research Avenues

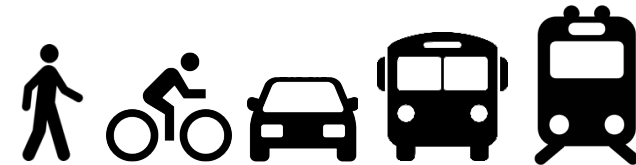
1. Street type preferences

- Diurnal patterns? Prefer certain types in morning/evening?
- Prefer certain types when climbing/descending?



2. Travel mode

- Identify travel mode from your data / GeoLife data
- Validate against travel mode from Posmo, or Google, if applicable



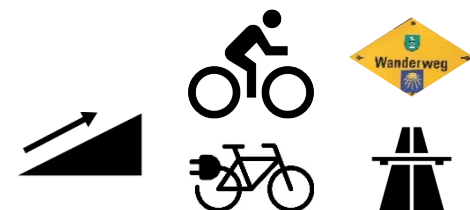
3. Weather impact

- Relate your mobility patterns to weather data
- Can you show an impact on the weather on the movement patterns (e.g. street type preferences, diurnal patterns, ...)



4. Or other ideas (depending on available data...)

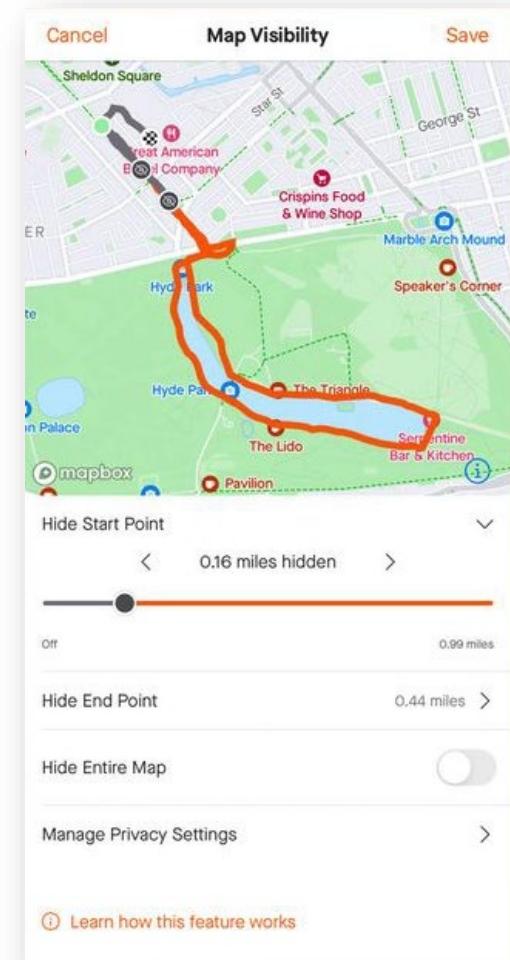
- Different mobility patterns between bikes and e-bikes?
- Patterns regarding slope?
- Distance travelled?
- Street types?



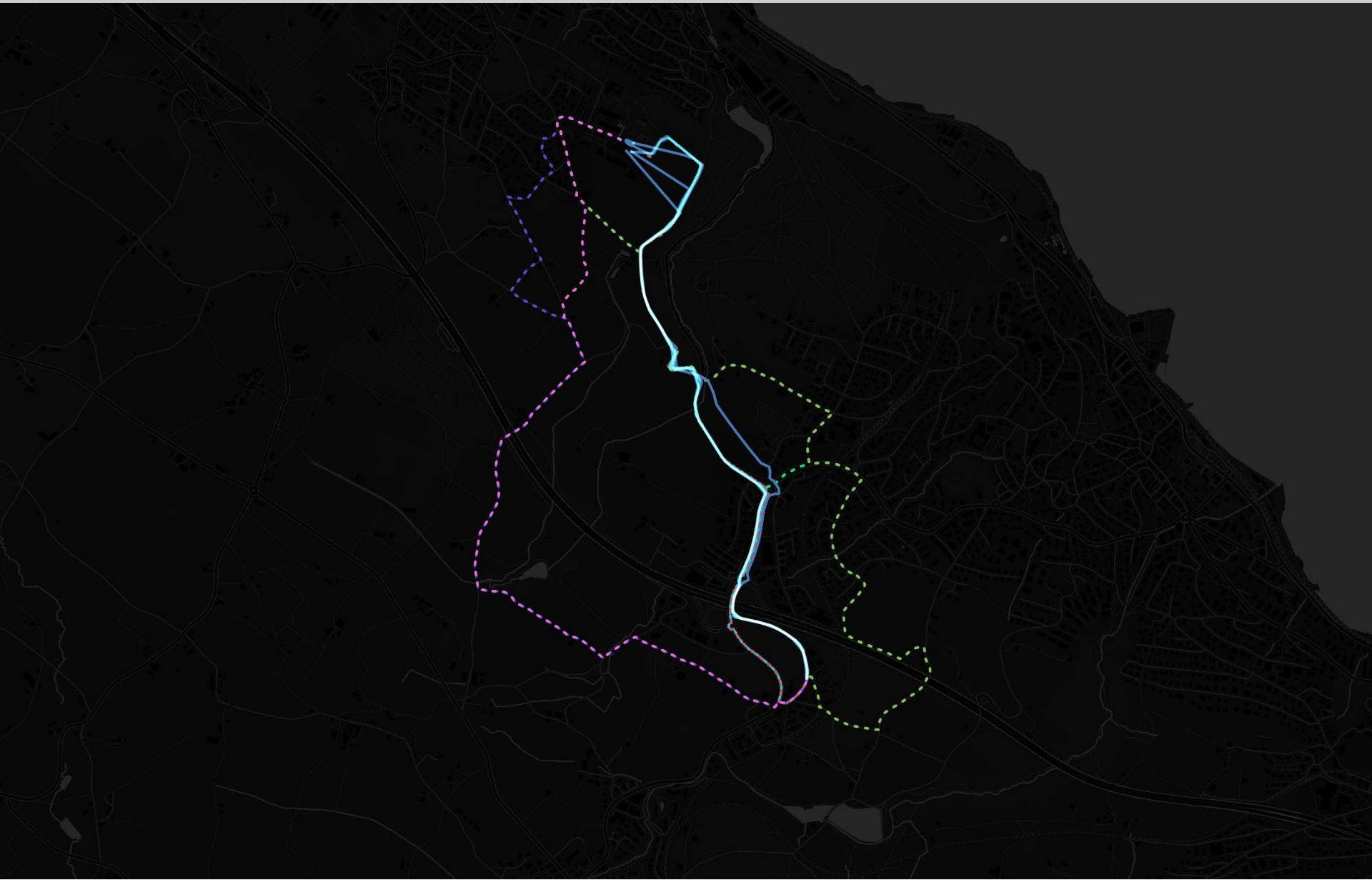
All projects

When deciding on a RQ consider the following:

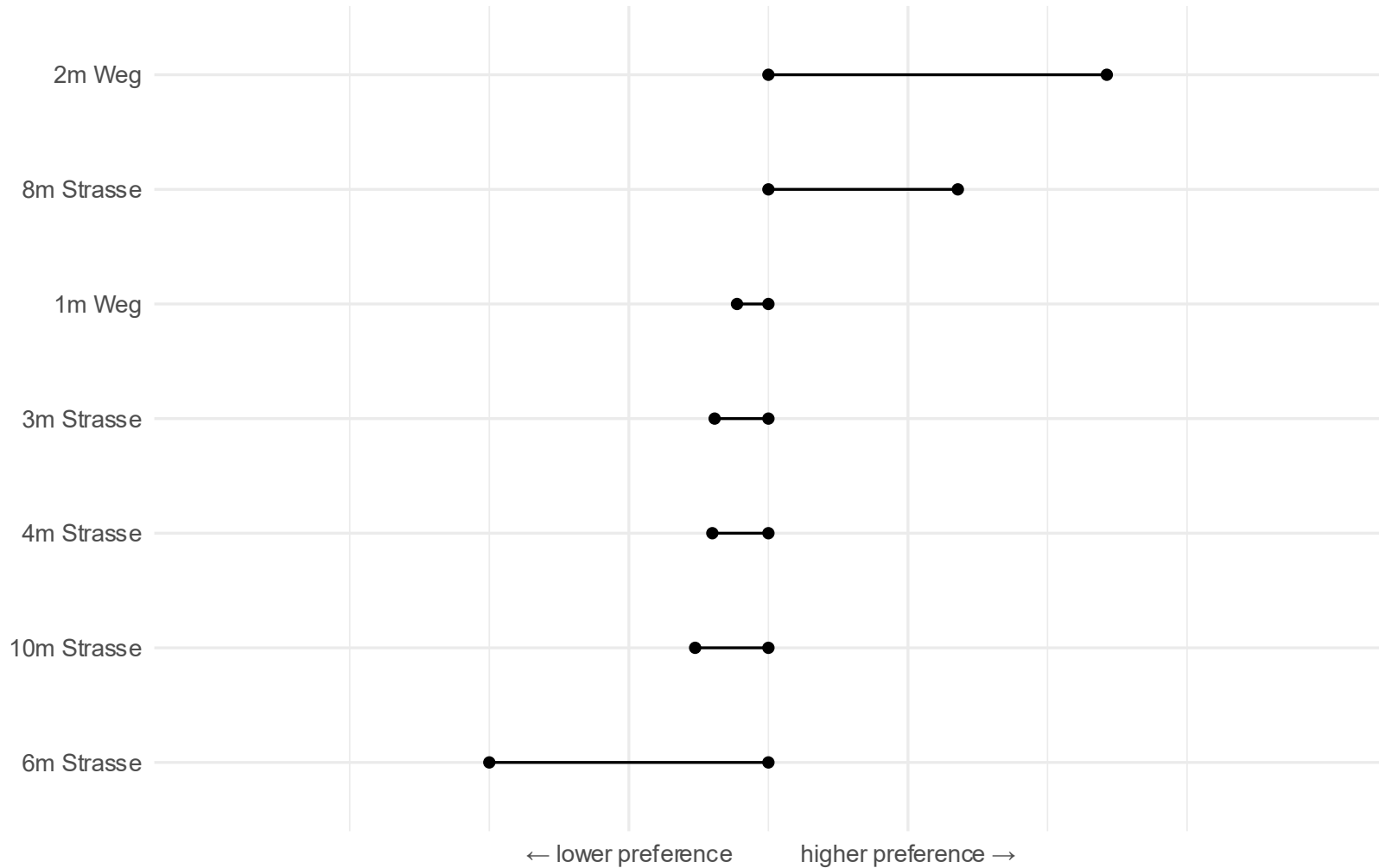
- Make sure the RQ is suited to your data (e.g., do you have ascends / descends?)
- Data Preprocessing and EDA is necessary and a lot of work:
 - With trackers, separate stops from moves.
 - Do you have a mix of different transport modes that you might have to differentiate first
 - Group locations into trajectories
 - Filter out obviously erroneous trajectories/segment
- Movement data is sensitive
 - If you are willing to make your report publicly visible, make sure no private information is shared (e.g. obfuscate home location, how to do this?)



Determine preference: Possible routes (dashed) vs travelled routes



Determine preference: Possible routes (dashed) vs travelled routes



Your tasks

1. Build **teams of two** and add the team to the list on Moodle



Build Groups for Semester Project

2. Formulate at least two **research questions** for your project

- Typical types of research questions for a methodological project start with “How can this and that be conceptualized/modelled/implemented...?” or “Can this and that pattern be efficiently and effectively detected in this and that data...?”

3. Develop a **research plan** for investigating the above research questions.

- What data do you need?
- Where do you get this data from?
- What tools do you need?
- Will you use extensions of tools you got to know in E1 – E5?
- Are there other R tools or even tools beyond R that you will be using in your project?

4. Summarize your research plan in a semester **project proposal**.

- Use the template given via github
- Submit your proposal until **17.05.2026**

5. Book and attend **coaching session**

- In this coaching session you will discuss your research plan and proposal with your tutors.
- Timeslots will be made available between **18.05. – 22.05.2026** (link will follow)

Your tasks

6. **Design and implement** your data science routines that allow you investigating your research questions.
 - You may do this preferably using R or any other tool that may help you (e.g. a GIS, or FME).
 - Present your results in plots, tables, and maps.
7. Prepare a short 3–4 minute **end-of-term presentation** introducing your project to the class for **Wednesday 03.06.2026**. Your presentation should at least cover the following issues:
 - Context of your project (application area, conceptual models, data structures, available data)
 - Research questions and best possible outcome of your project
 - Research plan
 - Work in progress, preliminary results
 - Encountered problems and ideas for plan B
8. **Finalize your project**
 - Include feedback from the coaching sessions and the end-of-term presentations

Your tasks

9. Report your work in a written **project report**. The report has two functions:
- It shall serve you as documentation of what you did, such that at a later stage you can use the report in one of your own projects.
 - It will be used to evaluate and mark your project.

Your report shall:

- cover how you went about investigating your research questions. Describe your data science ideas and how you implemented your ideas.
- present the **results** of your study and discuss them in the light of your research questions. What have you achieved and what would be further steps for future research?
- report **problems and limitations** you encountered along the way and the solutions you chose to overcome these, be it limitations with respect to the data sources, the tools or any other source of limitation.
- discuss your data science choices in the light of the theory covered in the lectures, group works, and your reading assignments.

Project schedule

zhaw			Patterns and Trends in Environmental Data MSc in Environment and Natural Resources FS26			Geo880 Computational Movement Analysis Master of Science (MSc) Geography			 University of Zurich ^{ZH}					
MI 08:00 - ca. 12:00 From 15.04.2026						Patrick Laube (laup@zhaw.ch), Nils Ratnaweera (rata@zhaw.ch) & Evelyn Terzer (terz@zhaw.ch)								
Week	Room	Date	Lesson Title	Data Science Topic	Case Study: Computational Movement Analysis	Readings Theory	Readings Skills Wickham, H. et al (2023). R for data science, 2 nd Edition: import, tidy, transform, visualize, and model data. * O'Reilly.	Reading Assignment	Theory-Recap	Group-work	R Exercises	Project	Submission/Assignment	
16	GA215	15.04.2026	L1 Modelling matters!	Modelling means abstracting the world Implications of modelling decisions data exploration with tidyverse	Introduction into movement ecology and computational movement analysis Conceptual data models for movement spaces and movement traces	R1.1 Laube (2016). Representation, trajectories, AAG Encycl R1.2 Laube (2014). Computational Movement Analysis, Springer, Chap.1, p. 1-7. R1.3 Laube (2014). Computational Movement Analysis, Springer, Chap.2, p. 9-27.	RS1.1 Introduction (10p) RS1.2 Chap 2 Workflow basics (6p) RS1.3 Chap 6 Workflow: Scripts and Projects (10p) RS1.4 Chap 7 Data Import (18p) RS1.5 Chap 17 Dates and Times (24p)	R2.1 RS2.1 R2.2 RS2.2	T1	Gw1	E1			
17	GA215	22.04.2026	L2 Data issues	Import and preprocess data Scale, Multi-scale analysis Filtering and aggregating data Data quality: Accuracy, Precision, Uncertainty	Deriving movement parameters (speed, acceleration, sinuosity) MapMatching	R2.1 Laube, P., & Purves, R. S. (2011). How fast is a cow? cross scale analysis of movement data. Transactions in GIS, 15(3), 401-418. R2.2 Fisher et al. (2004). Where is Helvellyn? Fuzziness of multi scale landscape morphometry, Transactions of the Institute of British Geographers 29.1 (2004): 106-128.	RS2.1 Chap3 Data Transformation (24p) RS2.2 Chap19 Joins (25p)	R3.1 RS3.1 R3.2 RS3.2 RS3.3	T2	Gw2	E2			
18	GA215	29.04.2026	L3: Reproducible and Publicly Visible Data Analysis	Literate Programming, Version Control, Websites, Git, GitHub	No additional input	R3.1 Peng, R. D. (2011). Reproducible research in computational science. Science, 334(6060), 1226-1227. R3.2 Valdez (2020): Making reproducible research simple using RMarkdown and the OSF. In <i>Social Computing and Social Media</i> . Springer International Publishing.	RS3.1 : Chap28 Quarto RS3.2 : Grolemond (2021): R RS3.3 : Bartlett (2016): Git fo					P Intro	E2	
19	GA215	06.05.2026	L4 Similarity and segmentation	Partitioning and structuring data Tidy data Comparing data	Stops and moves Trajectory segmentation Similarity measures and clustering	R4.1 Tao et al., (2021). A comparative analysis of trajectory similarity measures, <i>GIScience & Remote Sensing</i> 58.5 (2021): 643-669. R4.2 Toohy, K., & Duckham, M. (2015). Trajectory similarity measures. <i>SIGSPATIAL Special</i> 7(1), 43-50.	RS4.1 Chap1 Data visualization (28p) RS4.2 Chap10 Exploratory Data Analysis (23p)	R5.1 RS5.1 R5.2	T4	Gw4	E4	P	E3	
20	GA215	13.05.2026	L5 Defining and detecting patterns	Data mining and knowledge discovery in database Algorithmic pattern detection	Movement patterns (flocks, convoys, leadership, interaction, disturbance patterns)	R5.1 Laube (2014). Computational Movement Analysis, Springer, Chap.2, p. 29-58. R5.2 Dodge, S., Weibel, R., & Lautenschütz, A. K. (2008). Towards a taxonomy of movement patterns. <i>Information</i> 152.	RS5.1 Chap25 Functions (22p)	R6.1 R6.2	T5	Gw5	E5	P	E4	
So. 17.05.2026 Submission Project Proposal													P	Subm.
21	online	18.-22.05.2026	Project coaching sessions										P	
22	GA215	27.05.2026	L6 Context, Context, Context!	Semantics Spatial information Relating data	Context-Aware Movement Analysis; Semantic annotation of movement patterns, relating movement patterns to additional environmental data	R6.1 Gschwind, S. (2021). Context-Aware Movement Analysis, PhD Thesis UZH, Chapter 4. R6.2 Dodge, S., Bohrer, G., Weinzierl, R., Davidson, S. C., Kays, R., Douglas, D., ... & Wikelski, M. (2013). The environmental-data automated track annotation (Env-DATA) system: linking animal tracks with environmental data. <i>Movement Ecology</i> , 1(1), 3.		R7.1 R7.2	T6	Gw6	E6	P	E5	
23	GA215	03.06.2026	L7 Multi-Source Data	Data integration and data fusion	Combining multiple movement sensors (GPS, accelerometer, gyrometer)	R7.1 Borchert, S., & Weibel, R. (2014). Instantaneous advantage of felid sneak R7.2 B., Wang, Y., ... & Wilms, C. C. (2014). Instantaneous advantage of felid sneak R7.3 B., Wang, Y., ... & Wilms, C. C. (2014). Instantaneous advantage of felid sneak						P	E6 Ppres	
So. 21.06.2026 Submission project work													P	P

Proposal 17.05.2026

Coaching 18. – 22.05.2026

Presentations work in progress 03.06.2026

Submission 21.06.2026

Project Proposal

- Title
- Abstract (50-60 words)
- Research Questions (50-60 words)
- Results / products
- What data will you use?
- Analytical concepts (theory)
- R concepts / tools
- Risk analysis (with Plan B)
- What questions to us?

README

Proposal for Semester Project

Patterns & Trends in Environmental Data / Computational Movement Analysis Geo 880

Semester:	FS25
Data:	What type of data are you focussing on?
Title:	The title of your project
Student 1:	Name of Student 1
Student 2:	Name of Student 2

README

Proposal for Semester Project

Patterns & Trends in Environmental Data / Computational Movement Analysis Geo 880

Semester:	FS24
Data:	Strava bicycle data from several bike messengers in Zurich
Title:	Cycling Secrets: Decoding Bike Messenger Paths for Efficiency
Student 1:	Maurin Huonder
Student 2:	Patrick Greber

README

Abstract

This project investigates route choice modeling for bike messengers in Zurich. Firstly, we will compare the paths of chosen routes (deliveries) with a generated set of modeled routes (choice-set/alternatives) to estimate deviations from the most direct paths available, thereby assessing efficiency in terms of traveled distance. Secondly, we will adapt our definition of efficiency (shortest route) to implement the idea of resistance/convenience to our analysis. To achieve this, we will enrich Zurich's route network with additional attributes to establish a cost-path network. Attributes such as traveled distance, slope, traffic volumes, street type and width, and the number of intersections could be incorporated into the new network. An efficient route choice will then be defined by selecting options with an optimized cost-path ratio. Given potential time constraints, we will focus primarily on the first approach (shortest route) and consider the second approach depending on the remaining time budget.

Research Questions

- Do bike messengers always choose the shortest possible route during their deliveries? -> Efficiency in terms of travel distance
- How do street network attributes influence the route choice behaviour of bike messengers in Zurich? -> Efficiency in terms of an optimised cost-path ratio
- Is there a combination of above criteria that would be preferable in terms of speed/convenience?

Results / products

We anticipate that the observed route choices will align only partially with the shortest possible routes. Instead, the chosen routes are likely influenced by factors such as road type and slope. We assume a trade-off between the most direct path and resistance/convenience, with bike messengers leveraging their knowledge of the local street network to optimize this balance/trade-off.

Data

We will utilize movement data from Strava, collected by several bike messengers in Zurich. The data, stored in GPX files, encompasses approximately 60 shifts per messenger, with each shift including multiple trajectories/deliveries. The shifts vary in terms of distance traveled, working hours, and the number of deliveries. All contextual data for enriching the route network is sourced from open-source platforms:

- SwissTUM3D (street network, street type, and width)
- SwissALTI3D (slope)
- Motorized Individual Traffic Volume Data (traffic volume)
- OSM (traffic lights, intersections/junctions)

Formal requirements of the report

Your report should

- be in English or German
- be written in a **scientific writing style**.
- Length of report (approx. 15000 char (incl. spaces, incl. References list, excl. Code listing), 20000 char max)
- typically include text, maps, plots, appendices, code and references.
- be written using Quarto (see sample File in the template Repo)
- If used, use of generative AI documented & transparent?

Cycling Secrets

Decoding bike messenger paths for efficiency

AUTHOR
Maurin Huonder and Patrick Greber

PUBLISHED
June 23, 2024

► Code

Abstract

This work explores the possibility of determining how bike messengers in Zurich perceive their route choices. This is done by analyzing their trajectories. We compare path (choice-set/alternatives) in terms of time on 95 shift performed by 2 messengers on the Swisstm3d data set. For further information, see the full report.

Introduction

Route choice models play an important role in transport systems, GPS navigation, and understanding choice behavior is essential for many applications. Choice models can assess travel time, cost, number of alternatives, and other characteristics (e.g. gender, age, etc.) to understand travelers' behavior. Several studies have been conducted in different cities for different purposes (Sall, and Charlton 2011). In Copenhagen (Denmark), the Copenhagen City Council has been indicating a preference for cycling factors such as length, cycling

Differentiation of walking patterns

An attempt to differentiate walking patterns based on attributes and context information. Work for the module Patterns and Trends FS24

AUTHOR
Saskia Gianola and Sarah Wirth

- Preprocessing for attribute-based classification
- Preprocessing for CAMA based classification
- Attribute-classification
- CAMA based classification
- CART based classification

Abstract

This student project attempts to answer whether it is possible to differentiate between the walking pattern from recreation, travel and shopping by using time-stamped GPS locations. Three classification approaches are developed and evaluated. The first is based on the attributes speed, step length and acceleration. The second is a context aware movement analysis (CAMA). The third is a classification and regression tree (CART) algorithm that combines the attributes generated in the first and second approach. We can conclude that the attribute-based classification is not able to cleanly separate travel and recreation. For shopping, there was no clear pattern to be found, as the GPS signal is most often lost in the building. CART was able to classify the shopping data better. The CAMA approach performed best overall in classifying the activities.

Introduction

The aim of this paper is to compare different approaches to detect walking patterns. The different patterns that should be able to be distinguished are walking for recreational purposes, walking for commuting, and shopping. The underlying idea is that these walking types differs in their attributes and the environment

https://grebepat.github.io/cma_semester_project_group9/
https://zhaw-student.github.io/Semester_Project_FS24/

Formal requirements of the report

Your report should

- be in English or German
- be written in a **scientific writing** style.
- Length of report (approx. 15000 char (incl. spaces, incl. References list, excl. Code listing), 20000 char max)
- typically include text, maps, plots, appendices, code and references.
- be written using Quarto (see sample File in the template Repo)
- If used, use of generative AI documented & transparent?

Marking criteria semester project Patterns & Trends / GEO 880 FS25

laup, 05.03.2025

1. Study design

- Research questions are clear, appropriate, realistic, addressable
- Are study design choices motivated from the theory CMA?
- Originality? Is it a simple extension of the exercises or are there own ideas?

2. Argument and Logic

- Students have mastered the theory and use it for their argument, with references
- Students show understanding of theory
- What has been done in terms of literature review?

3. Results

- What was achieved overall?
- How well are the results presented?
- How well are the results discussed in the light of the theory?

4. Discussion and Conclusions

- Are the conclusions drawn from the project adequate and coherent?
- Are problems that showed up been reported and alternative solutions proposed?
- Have data science choices been discussed in the light of the theory?

5. Implementation

- How was research implemented addressing the Research questions?
- What about problems and limitations and strategies overcoming these?
- Simple solutions vs. own original techniques
- Is the code properly commented/annotated?

6. Craftsmanship

- How much effort was put in documenting the work?
- Is the structure reasonable and clear?
- Length of report (approx. 15000 char (incl. spaces, incl. References list, excl. Code listing), 20000 char max)
- Is the language clear and correct?
- Are references used, correctly cited and listed?
- If used, is the use of Generative AI (e.g. ChatGPT) documented and transparent?
- Are figures and tables clear and produced to high standards?
- Overall effort and investment

Use of GenAI



- *basierend auf Z-RL-Richtlinie KI bei Leistungsnachweisen sowie Z-RL-Richtlinie Anhang Deklarationspflicht KI bei Arbeiten (Version: 1.1.0, 01.03.2025).*

3. Declaration obligation

Generative AI systems must be cited in the same way as other aids, resources and sources if the output (see definition under section 5 of the AIG) generated by such tools is incorporated in a graded assignment. The share or extent of the contribution made by generative AI systems to the creative output generated as part of a graded assignment must be recognisable to third parties.

The following declaration obligations apply within the scope of this Annex:

- I. A generative AI system must be **cited in the text of a graded assignment** if content (text, images, data, etc.) created using this tool is paraphrased, quoted or incorporated in words to the same effect in the graded assignment in question.

Citation guidelines, using the example of the American Psychology Association (APA)²:

1. Author of the model (e.g. OpenAI as the author of the ChatGPT large language model)
2. Date (i.e. the year in which the generative AI system was used (and not the exact date of use))

When prompted with "Is the left brain right brain divide real or a metaphor?" the ChatGPT-generated text indicated that although the two brain hemispheres are somewhat specialized, "the notation that people can be characterized as 'left-brained' or 'right-brained' is considered to be an oversimplification and a popular myth" (OpenAI, 2023).

Reference

OpenAI. (2023). *ChatGPT* (Mar 14 version) [Large language model].

<https://chat.openai.com/chat>

Use of GenAI



- *basierend auf Z-RL-Richtlinie KI bei Leistungsnachweisen sowie Z-RL-Richtlinie Anhang Deklarationspflicht KI bei Arbeiten (Version: 1.1.0, 01.03.2025).*

- III. The **prompts** that were used in the dialogue with the generative AI systems as well as the corresponding output **do not have to be declared**, i.e. they do not have to be stated or listed (see image identifiers as an exception under section 3.I) either as an “in-text reference” (section 3.I) or as a “list of aids reference” (section 3.II).
- IV. In order to make it easier to recognise the share or extent of the contribution made by generative AI systems to the creative output generated as part of a graded assignment as well as to document the quality of the student’s or continuing education participant’s own scientific work, **a description of how generative AI systems were used in the graded assignment must generally be provided in the introduction or in the method section.** The description must include an explanation of the extent to which generative AI systems have been used as a means of stimulating thought or as a source of inspiration. If generative AI systems are also used for purposes described under section 3.I or 3.II, this must likewise be documented. If the purpose of use is specifically stated in the list of

Use of GenAI (fact sheet)



Use of generative AI for graded assignments

This information sheet is based on:

- [The guidelines on the use of generative AI systems as part of assessments](#)
- [The supplementary annex to the guidelines](#)

1. General

In principle, the use of generative AI tools for graded assignments must be declared. This information sheet provides you with step-by-step guidance in fulfilling this requirement.

2. Obligations when using generative AI systems

Your duties when using generative AI

- **You are responsible for the quality of the content:**
even if you correctly declare the use of generative AI, you are still required to check the relevance, truthfulness and accuracy of the generative AI tools used and the output they produce.
- **Your graded assignment must represent your own work:**
generative AI may only be used in a supportive capacity. The share or extent of the contribution made by generative AI tools to the creative output generated as part of your graded assignment must be recognisable to third parties.
- **Not all kinds of data may be processed using generative AI systems:**
in principle, the processing of the following kinds of data is not permitted: particularly sensitive personal data (e.g. data about religious beliefs, health or genetic data) as well as business and trade secrets (of legal entities).

Use of GenAI (fact sheet)



3. Overview: step-by-step guide for correctly declaring the use of generative AI

Has your degree programme or lecturer defined rules for your graded assignments with respect to the use of generative AI tools?						
Yes	Don't know	No				
↓	↓	↓				
The instructions issued by your lecturer apply.	Ask your lecturers for more information.	Did you use generative AI tools when preparing your graded assignment?				
		No	Yes,			
			- as a formulation aid - as a spelling aid - for autocompletion purposes	- as a means of stimulating thought - as a source of inspiration	- output used verbatim or with words to the same effect - to create images	otherwise - to create text - to (further) edit
Declaration as...						
IN-TEXT REFERENCE <u>AI output must be correctly cited in the text</u>		—	—	—	✓	—
LIST OF AIDS REFERENCE <u>AI tools and the purpose of their use must be listed</u>		—	—	—	✓	✓
METHOD REFERENCE <u>The use of AI must be described and reflected upon</u>		—	—	✓	✓	✓

This information is for guidance only. In cases of doubt, please consult the annex to these guidelines entitled [Obligation to declare the use of generative AI for graded assignments](#) or contact your lecturer.

Reference GenAI?



The screenshot shows a web browser window with the URL <https://library-guides.ucl.ac.uk/referencing-plagiarism/acknowledging-genai>. The page is titled "References, citations and avoiding plagiarism" and is part of the "Library Services" section. The main heading is "References, citations and avoiding plagiarism", and the sub-heading is "Acknowledging the use of generative AI and referencing generative AI". The page content includes an introduction to the function and practice of referencing your sources, a list of related resources, and a sidebar with navigation links.

References, citations and avoiding plagiarism

An introduction to the function and practice of referencing your sources

Acknowledging the use of generative AI and referencing generative AI

This guidance presents UCL's general approach to acknowledging the use of generative AI and referencing generative AI. Generative AI (GenAI) is evolving rapidly and there is not yet general consensus on how to acknowledge and reference it. This guidance will therefore continue to be reviewed and updated.

- [Considerations for using generative AI in academic work](#)
- [Acknowledging the use of generative AI in academic work](#)
- [In-text citations and inclusion of AI generated output in a reference list](#)
- [Use of standardised referencing styles](#)

Considerations for using generative AI in academic work

Related resources

- [Generative AI Hub](#)
UCL guidance: hub bringing together all the latest information, resources and guidance on using Artificial Intelligence in education.
- [Engaging with AI in your education and assessment](#)
UCL student guidance on how you might engage with Artificial Intelligence (AI) in your assessments, effectively and ethically.
- [Generative AI and library skills](#)
This LibrarySkills@UCL

Navigation sidebar:

- References, citations and avoiding plagiarism
- Understanding a reference
- Managing your references
- How to reference
- Acknowledging and referencing GenAI**
- Referencing styles
- Plagiarism
- Further help

Reference GenAI?

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Recommendations on the Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence at UZH



AI-generated image of UZH, generated in Deep Dream Generator based on a photograph of the main building.

Use of artificial intelligence in Teaching

UZH has a broad range of teaching and learning formats. The way in which generative artificial intelligence AI can be used in the various formats varies widely depending on the discipline and subject matter.

Questions?

